



Smartphones with HD displays

We have five smartphones that can give the iPhone 4's Retina Display a run for its money
<http://bit.ly/IQPDG8>



Apps for Indian users

A look at 10 apps that can optimize your smartphone for use in India
<http://bit.ly/IY1Bu7>

Android 4.0 budget tablet from Micromax

Micromax has launched the Funbook tablet, and it's one of the few Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich-based slates in India. Priced at ₹6,499, the Funbook features a 7-inch display with 800x480 pixel resolution, a 1.2GHz Cortex A8 processor with a Mali GPU, and 512MB RAM.



Micromax Funbook

The Funbook comes with 4GB onboard memory, expandable via a microSD card, a 2,800 mAh battery, USB 3G dongle support and a 0.3 megapixel front-facing camera. The Funbook comes with access to 600 movies in nine languages, over 6,000 songs and 4,000 videos and a Live TV app. Micromax also offers Tata's Photon+ EV-DO data card with 1 GB of additional download for two months.

The battery is rumoured to last not more than 3-4 hours with continuous usage.

Galaxy SIII to come with Exynos 4 quad-core processor

Samsung has said that its next generation Galaxy Smartphone will house a quad-Core processor. The new processor called Exynos 4 Quad, is a 32nm processor. The next generation Samsung Galaxy smartphone, so far known as the Samsung Galaxy SIII is expected to be unveiled next month. The Exynos 4 Quad will not only be used in smartphones but in Samsung's tablets as well. The chip will be clocked at 1.4GHz.

The fact that the processor in the Samsung Galaxy S III is a

32nm chip is a big deal breaker considering that the third generation iPad and the iPhone 4 and 4S use 45nm chipsets.

In a statement released, Samsung said, "Already in production, the Exynos 4 Quad is scheduled to be adopted first into Samsung's next Galaxy smartphone that will officially be announced in May. The Exynos 4 Quad processor is a crucial element in providing our customers with a PC-like experience on mobile devices. Samsung's next Galaxy device, which will be officially announced soon,

offers uncompromised performance and ground breaking multi-tasking features."

The press release also says, "In addition, the new processor was architected to drive up to 1366 x 768 (WXGA) display and incorporates a full HD 30 frame per second video hardware codec engine for high resolution 1080p video recording and play-back, an embedded image signal processor interface for high-quality camera functionality and an HDMI 1.4 interface for sharp and crisp multimedia content transmission."

HCL's ICS tab: all study and no Play (Store)

Similar to Micromax's Funbook which bundles educational content, comes a tablet from HCL costing about a grand and a half more. The company has also launched an Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich-based tablet called HCL ME Tab U1, priced at ₹7,999.

The tablet will also be launched with two educational variants: MyEdu Tab K12 (₹11,499) and MyEdu Tab HE (₹9,999). None of the three HCL tablets feature access to the Google Play Store. Instead, they get the HCL SlideMe Appstore.

All three tablets bear identical specifications, with the only difference being that the two education variants



Nargis Faqri at the HCL ME Tab launch

– HCL MyEdu Tab K12 and HCL MyEdu Tab HE – come with pre-installed educational content meant for students of high-school (including NCERT books) and college, respectively.

They'll also feature access to a HCL cloud storage service called HCL Touch. Specifications include a

7-inch (800x480) capacitive display, 1GHz ARM Cortex A8 processor, 512MB RAM, 4GB built-in storage expandable via microSD card (maximum card size is 32 GB), 0.3MP front-facing camera, no rear camera, Wi-Fi connectivity, 3G connectivity via USB dongle, mini USB, and a 3,600 mAh battery. It also has a 1-year warranty.



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